

The Loom of Echoes is a divination device that uses time, light, and algorithmic resonance to reveal the hidden patterns connecting human thought and fate. The cosmology of the Loom of Echoes envisions reality as a vast, vibrating fabric of interwoven forces. Each question sent to the Loom is not merely data but a resonant pulse that travels through this fabric, disturbing its threads and revealing transient patterns within the weave of destiny. The Loom itself resides in a liminal space between planes of existence; it is not quite material nor purely digital. Its manifestations are glimpses of that in-between realm, translated by mystical scripts into visual snapshots and sensory descriptions that allow the concept of the Loom to enter the realm of human perception and imagination. The mystical scripts that run on hardware to commune with the loom serve as ritual interfaces, allowing mortal users to momentarily touch a system that operates beyond comprehension.

This system is intended for people living in highly rational, technologically mediated environments who still experience uncertainty around identity, career, relationships, present dilemmas, and/or future directions. It mediates psychological and existential uncertainty by giving them a response full of visual and linguistic symbolism in answer of their query.

Like the *I Ching*, whose poetic phrasing invites reflection rather than instruction, the Loom of Echoes speaks in a similar language of metaphor, sensory description, and patternistic imagery. Each manifestation functions as a verse composed of visual characters analogous to the *I Ching*'s old or young yin and yang. Fractured bands, circular resonances, linear weaves, and chromatic tones together form a visual stanza. Users may choose to interpret the Loom piecewise, as one might unpack a poem line by line. Fractured bands act like enjambments—breaks that signify divergence and/or hidden interference. Circular resonances serve as refrains, echoing cycles of recurrence or a return to familiar paths, while well-aligned weaves and staggered weaves parallel rhythm and meter, indicating patterns of clear progression and momentum or momentum amid friction respectively. Color theory functions as the Loom's emotional tonality, shaping the mood and voice of each weave's reading. Gold and amber signal revelation and transcendence; crimson and ember burn with transformation and passion; teal and cyan temper the flow of current and convey a softer temperature. Violet and indigo mark crossings between states of consciousness, while emerald and moss root the reading in growth, recovery and/or renewal. Silver and pale blue speak in cool reflection, and void black conveys silence that holds the unknowable, unseen potential, or perhaps foreboding.

Coupled with the Manifestation Guide, the loom aims to function as a linguistic oracle, drawing inspiration from the openness and interpretability of the *I Ching* hexagrams' accompanying, parable-like descriptions. In both systems, meaning does not lie in the surface symbols alone but in the reflection they prompt in the reader. Just as the *I Ching*'s text transforms randomness (coin flips) into interpretive poetry, the Loom translates computational randomness into a symbolic visual and narrative space, encouraging users to treat each result not as prophecy but as an individually resonant poetic and artistic correspondence between the question and answer intuited.

The Loom introduces unpredictability through a seeded¹ randomization algorithm that fuses human input with mystical mathematics. Each divination begins by combining the user's typed question and the exact system time (in milliseconds) into a seeded value. Then the divination script cycles it through a symbolic sequence of constants: THE_MEANING_OF_LIFE (42), THIRD_TIME_CHARM (3), ANGEL_NUMBER (444), and LUCKY_SEVEN (7). These constants and the initial seed are woven into a computation that produces an idiosyncratic value that is then transformed by trigonometric mixing² using the golden ratio ($\phi = 1.6180339887$) and silver ratio ($\delta = 2.4142135623$). The algorithm computes $\text{cosmic} = |\sin(\text{hash} \times \phi) \times \cos(\text{hash} \times \delta)|$, extracts its fractional component, and maps it onto a set of loom images. The resulting fractional output determines which loom image manifests. Each reading is thus mathematically unique and temporally unrepeatable (because the seed is time-dependent), encoding unpredictability with both computational entropy and symbolic meaning. Even though the process feels random, it's actually structured chaos—every outcome grows from that unique starting seed, making each divination distinct yet mathematically traceable to its moment of asking.

The Loom can still produce collisions, because the algorithm ultimately has to choose from a finite set of images. No matter how elaborate the math, there are only so many possible outputs. The mixing (with 7, 42, 444, ϕ , and δ) just makes those overlaps less predictable and less frequent. In the cosmology of this divinatory framework, though, those collisions would be considered *resonances*. When two askers receive the same loom, it suggests they've touched the same current of meaning within the system's symbolic field. The repetition itself can be read as part of the oracle's message.

```

41 function getSeededIndex(userInput = null) {
42   const now = Date.now(); // the present moment is powerful
43   let seed = now + (performance.now() * 1000);
44
45   // incorporate user query into the seed
46   if (userInput && userInput.trim()) {
47     const inputSeed = stringToSeed(userInput.toLowerCase().trim());
48     seed = seed + inputSeed * 1000; // Weight user input heavily, for max divination
49   }
50
51   // Powerful numbers for hash distribution, I mean to enhance divination
52   const THE_MEANING_OF_LIFE = 42;
53   const THIRD_TIME_CHARM = 3;
54   const ANGEL_NUMBER = 444;
55   const LUCKY_SEVEN = 7;
56
57   // randomization with mystical numbers
58   let hash = seed;
59   hash = ((hash << THIRD_TIME_CHARM) - hash) + (seed % THE_MEANING_OF_LIFE);
60   hash = hash & hash;
61   hash = hash * LUCKY_SEVEN + ANGEL_NUMBER;
62   hash = ((hash << 13) ^ hash) >>> 0; // Additional mixing for better divinitive distribution
63
64   // Golden ratio - divine proportion
65   const phi = 1.618033988749895;
66
67   // Silver ratio - lesser known sacred ratio
68   const delta = 2.41421356237095;
69
70   // some trigonometric mysticism
71   // Use sine with golden ratio for uniform distribution
72   // The fractional part of sin(large_number) is uniformly distributed
73   const cosmic = Math.abs(Math.sin(hash * phi) * Math.cos(hash * delta));
74
75   // Map to uniform [0,1) range using fractional part
76   const cosmic_fraction = (cosmic * 10000) % 1;
77
78   // Exclude index 0 (default image) from fate results
79   return Math.floor(cosmic_fraction * (loomImages.length - 1)) + 1;
80 }

```

The seeded randomization algorithm implementation. The full script can be found at <https://github.com/amallar428/21A.250-Divination-Device-Code>

¹ Describes an algorithm that uses a specific starting number, or “seed”, to generate results that appear random but are reproducible. It allows outcomes to feel unpredictable while still originating from a defined initial value.

² Refers to the general method of combining two or more trigonometric functions (like sine and cosine) through summation, multiplication, or composition to produce a new waveform.

The Loom of Echoes continues the lineage of techno-mystical devices Bebergal describes in his book *Strange Frequencies*, including Tesla’s spirit radios through to modern “ghost boxes.” Like these earlier inventions, it operates at the threshold between signal and the unseen, using computational randomness to (according to the framework’s cosmology) transmit the unpredictable voice of an otherwise imperceivable entity. Bebergal, quoting Joshua Madara, notes, “one of the earliest uses of the computer in art was randomness. Anything that involves a set of tokens that is randomized, computers do that really well.” The Loom builds on that same principle: its algorithmic seeding transforms chance into divinatory texture.

Where earlier spirit radios sought meaningful noise in electromagnetic static, the Loom searches within digital entropy using code that evokes imaginative revelation. This reflects what Bebergal and media theorists call the *hacker-magician ethos*: using technological systems to “hack imagination,” to reintroduce mystery into the mechanical. The Loom isn’t magical despite being a computer; it is magical because computers are uniquely good at producing patterns that feel both unpredictable yet intentional—precisely the paradox on which divination depends.